Q+A

MASTER OF THE GAME

Badminton player **Prannoy H.S.** is on a career high after winning the men's singles crown at Malaysia Masters 2023

with Shail Desai

Q. You almost pulled out of the Malaysia Masters...
I had a small hip injury, nothing serious but there was a little pain. I wanted to be really sure that it was not something that we have to worry about in the coming weeks. I had scans just before the tournament and the doctors gave me the go ahead to play.

Q. With the World Championship and Asian Games this year and the Paris Olympics in 2024, what are some things you'd like to work on in the months ahead?
Olympic qualification is a long period, so as of now, the idea is to take things on a weekly basis. The important thing is to ensure that there are no niggles, no injuries, and that there are breaks between tournaments to recharge.

Q. Injuries have constantly afflicted your career, as have some close losses. How do you deal with these setbacks?
That's part and parcel of every sportsperson's journey. Injuries have only made me stronger. I've learnt quite a lot about my body. I'd say in the last few years, I've been brilliant at managing my body and that's helped me come back from being World No. 35 into the Top 10.

Q. This is your first World Tour title. What does it mean to you?
It's a very special one. In the past, I had come really close to winning a title on many occasions, but it didn't happen. To have such a big win at the start of the Olympic qualification period is a big boost. I'll be getting into a lot of tournaments soon and that will give me confidence on court.

